

Moderna slovenska arhitektura - Radikalne, socialne in kontekstualne prakse

Modern Slovenian Architecture – Radical, Social and Contextual Practices

Uvod

Moderna slovenska arhitektura 20. stoletja in z njo povezana problematika njenega obstoja, obnove in varovanja ima svoje korenine v različnih zgodovinskih dogodkih in usmeritvah, ki jih imenujem radikalne, socialne in kontekstualne prakse. Značilnosti vsake izmed teh praks narekujejo tudi specifične pristope k varovanju.

Radikalne prakse so vezane na pojme avantgarde, minljivosti, mladosti, akcije, utopije, zanikanju tradicije in dekonstrukciji. Na likovnem področju sta najpomembnejša slovenska predstavnika Avgust Černigoj in Ferdo Delak. Socialne prakse so intenzivneje prišle do izraza v dveh obdobjih; prvič, v povezavi s prvo svetovno vojno, veliko gospodarsko krizo v 20. in 30. letih prejšnjega stoletja, z reševanjem problemov rastoče industrije in delavskega razreda ter s tem povezano potrebo po funkcionalnosti in ekonomiki gradnje. Najpomembnejši predstavniki so Ivan Vurnik, France Tomažič in Vladimir Šubic. Drugič, po drugi svetovni vojni, ko je bilo potrebno v kratkem času in z majhnimi sredstvi zgraditi novo socialistično državo, s poudarjeno skrbjo za industrijo, stanovanja, zdravstvo in šolstvo. V to obdobje sodijo tudi začetki montažne stanovanjske gradnje pri nas, kjer je pionirsko vlogo odigral arhitekt Danilo Fürst. Tu so bile v ospredju predvsem velike projektantske organizacije in inštituti, pomembno vlogo pa je imelo tudi Društvo arhitektov Slovenije. Kontekstualne prakse slovenske arhitekture 20. stoletja so vezane na osebno interpretacijo tradicij dunajske in ljubljanske arhitekturne šole in funkcionalnega izročila slovenskega podeželja ter s svojo pojavnostjo izražajo značaj naroda. Najpomembnejša predstavnika sta Jože Plečnik in Edvard Ravnikar.

Seveda so znotraj te delitve prisotni prepleti, predvsem med prvo in drugo ter drugo in tretjo skupino, v enem od predstavljenih primerov pa tudi med prvo in tretjo. Namen delitve je znotraj posamezne skupine izpostaviti značilnosti, ki bi pripomogle k natančnejšemu razumevanju, vrednotenju in primernemu varovanju te arhitekture. V besedilu po posameznih sklopih razlagam tudi besedo »moderen«, saj ima ta beseda v vsakem sklopu drugačen pomen.

Radikalne prakse

Naj za uvod spomnim na radikalen dogodek, ki je, poleg potresa l. 1895, ki ga štejemo za začetek modernega razvoja Ljubljane, v veliki meri zaznamoval kulturno-politično usmeritev slovenskega prebivalstva na začetku 20. stoletja; to je bil požig Slovenskega narodnega doma v Trstu. Občina Trst je bila v začetku stoletja del Avstro-Ogrske monarhije. Po podatkih tržaškega zgodovinarja Pietra Kandlerja je bilo sredi 19. stoletja slovensko prebivalstvo v tej občini četrtinsko. Leta 1900 so se odločili za gradnjo Slovenskega narodnega doma, ki je bil hkrati hranilnica, kulturna ustanova in hotel s kavarno. Načrte zanj je izdelal slovenski arhitekt Maks Fabiani, katerega mati je bila Tržačanka in je bil eden najbolj cenjenih arhitektov Avstro-Ogrske monarhije. Stavbo, ki je bila dokončana l. 1904 in je predstavljala centralno finančno in kulturno ustanovo, ne le za Slovence, ampak za vse slovanske narode, živeče v Trstu, so l. 1920 požgali italijanski fašisti. Čeprav so jo pozneje obnovili, nikdar

Introduction

Modern Slovenian architecture of the 20th century and the related problems of its existence, restoration and preservation are rooted in various historical events and currents, which I address as Radical, Social and Contextual practices. The properties of each of these practices also dictate the specific approaches to their preservation. Radical practices intertwine with the notions of the avant-garde, of transience, action, utopia, denial of the traditional, and deconstruction. The two most significant Slovenian representatives of these practices in the field of visual arts are Avgust Černigoj and Ferdo Delak. Social practices became more notable during two different periods: the first in connection to the First World War, the Great Depression in the 20s and the 30s, and the subsequent need for functional and economical construction. The foremost Slovenian representatives of this approach are Ivan Vurnik, France Tomažič and Vladimir Šubic. The second period took place after the Second World War, when little time and resources were available to build a new socialist state with emphasis on industry, housing, healthcare and schooling. This period was also the start of prefabricated construction in Slovenia, with architect Danilo Fürst as its trailblazer. At the forefront were a number of large project-engineering organisations and institutes, with the Slovenian Architects' Association also playing a significant part. The Contextual practices of 20th-century Slovenian architecture relate to personal interpretations of the traditions of the Vienna and Ljubljana schools of architecture, and the functional heritage of Slovenia's countryside; with its flowering, the nation's character is expressed. Leading representatives include Jože Plečnik and Edvard Ravnikar.

Of course there are other links within this division, especially among the first two and the second two groups, and even among the first and the third group on one occasion. The purpose of these distinctions is to stress those characteristics within an individual group that facilitate accurate understanding, valuation and appropriate preservation of this architecture. I also set out to explain the term "Modern" within different segments, as the word bears a different meaning in each of those segments.

Radical Practices

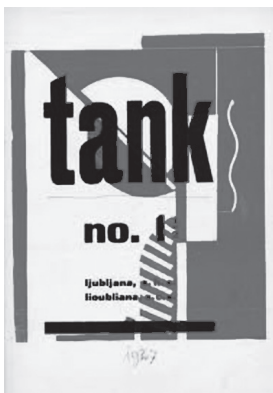
First, let me call to mind a significant event that, along with the 1895 earthquake, which we consider the foundation of Ljubljana's modern evolution, greatly marked the cultural-political course of the Slovenian population at the beginning of the 20th century; the arson of the Slovenian Narodni dom (House of Culture) in Trieste. The municipality of Trieste was part of the Austro-Hungarian Empire at the beginning of the century. According to information provided by local historian Pietro Kandler, Slovenes represented a quarter of the population in mid-19th century Trieste. In 1900, construction of the Slovenian House of Culture started, with the building also serving as a savings bank, a cultural institution and a hotel/café. The plans were produced by the Slovenian architect Maks Fabiani, whose mother was from Trieste and who was one of the most distinguished architects of the Austro-Hungarian Empire. The building, completed in 1904, represented a central financial and cultural

- 1 Požig Slovenskega narodnega doma v Trstu, 1920
- 2 Avgust Černigoj: naslovnica revije Tank, 1927
- 3 Avgust Černigoj: portret Srečka Kosovela, 1926
- 4 Avgust Černigoj: arhitekturna študija, 1924

več ni služila svojemu prvotnemu namenu. Ta radikalna gesta italijanskih fašistov je močno vplivala na usmeritev slovenske mladine in intelektualcev v boju proti fašizmu. Po mnenju Borisa Pahorja je na znano pesem Ekstaza smrti Srečka Kosovela vplival prav požig Slovenskega kulturnega doma v Trstu: »Komaj rojen, že goriš v ognju večera, vsa morja so rdeča, vsa morja polna krvi, vsa jezera, in vode ni; vode ni, da bi pral svojo krivdo, da bi opral svoje srce ta človek, vode ni, da pogasil bi z njo žejo po tihi, zeleni jutranji prirodi.«



Provincialna Ljubljana je bila v dvajsetih letih prejšnjega stoletja mali manifestativni center prvih avantgardnih idej, ki so se večinoma rojevale na Primorskem. V Trstu rojeni Slovenec Avgust Černigoj se je z idejami italijanskega futurizma seznanil v zgodnjih 20. letih, med bivanjem v Bologni. Študij je nadaljeval v Münchnu in na weimarskem Bauhausu. Ni bil arhitekt, si je pa v svojih manifestih, scenografijah in razstavah, po vzoru Bauhauza, prizadeval za povezanost vseh umetniških panog. Je utemeljitelj slovenskega konstruktivizma. Krajši čas je imel v Ljubljani svojo šolo. Bil je dober prijatelj Srečka Kosovela in tudi asistent arhitekta Rada Kregarja na ljubljanski tehnični šoli. Ljubljani, kjer je naskok hodil v delavskem kombinezonu, je prvi predstavil kolaž in umetniško-politično provokacijo, zato se je bil prisiljen vrniti v Trst, kjer je tudi odprl svojo šolo. Leta 1926 sta skupaj s Ferdom Delakom napisala konstruktivistični manifest v revijo Mladina, I. 1927 pa izdala revijo Tank. Leta 1928 sta nastopila v Berlinu. Svoje delo, pa tudi delo nekaterih drugih slovenskih ustvarjalcev, sta I. 1929 predstavila v deseti številki revije »Der Sturm«, ki je bila v celoti posvečena slovenskemu avantgardnemu ustvarjanju.



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institution – not only to Slovenes but also to all Slav nations living in Trieste – and was burned down by Italian fascists in 1920. Although it was later restored, it never again served its original purpose. This radical move by the Italian fascists strongly influenced the direction of the Slovenian young people and intelligentsia in the battle against fascism. According to Boris Pahor, it was that very arson that influenced Srečko Kosovel's famous poem, The Ecstasy of Death: "Only just born, yet burning in the evening fire/every sea is red, every sea/ is full of blood, every lake, and no water;/no water for this man to wash away/his guilt, to wash his heart,/no water that would help him quench/his thirst for the silent, green morning nature."

The provincial Ljubljana of the 20s was a true little centre for the manifestation of the first avant-garde ideas, coming mostly from the Littoral region. The Trieste-born Slovenian Avgust Černigoj became acquainted with the ideas of Italian Futurism in the early 20s, while living in Bologna. He resumed his studies in Munich and at the Bauhaus in Weimar. Though not an architect himself, he strived through his manifestos, scenography and exhibitions, towards linking all branches of art. He is considered the founder of Slovenian Constructivism. For a brief period, he ran his own school in Ljubljana. He was a good friend of Srečko Kosovel and an assistant to the architect Rado Kregar at the Ljubljana Technical School. He was the first to introduce collage and artistic-political provocation to Ljubljana – where he strolled the streets in overalls – and was therefore made to return to Trieste, where he later opened his school. He and Ferdo Delak wrote a Constructivist manifesto for an edition of Mladina magazine in 1926, and launched Tank magazine in 1927. A year later, they performed in Berlin. They presented Černigoj's work, along with that of other Slovenian artists, in the tenth issue of Der Sturm magazine, which featured exclusively Slovenian avant-garde art.



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Zanimivo je, da prvi ohranjen zapis besede »moderen« datira v leto 494 našega štetja, ko sta besedi »modernus pontifex« zapisani v zvezi z imenovanjem papeža Galesiusa I.¹ Radikalno nov je Plečnikov pristop k oblikovanju cerkvenega prostora, saj je nekatere njegove inovacije iz začetka 20. stoletja (horizontalna ladja) l. 1962 potrdil tudi II. vatikanski koncil. To dejstvo je pripomoglo k odločitvi, da se v pričujoči selekciji moderne slovenske arhitekture od Plečnikovih del, poleg NUK-a, predstavijo le cerkve, saj bi sicer Plečnikova dela po številu absolutno presegala ostale moderne slovenske avtorje.

Na morda najbolj absurden primer radikalnih praks pri nas kaže usoda cerkve sv. Krištofa v Ljubljani. Na območju Bežigrada, kjer je danes Gospodarsko razstavišče, točneje, kjer stoji okrogli paviljon Jurček, je nekoč stala majhna gotska pokopališka cerkvica, ki naj bi jo l. 1708 najslavnejši slovenski baročni arhitekt Gregor Maček povečal in barokiziral. Cerkev je zaradi prostorske stiske med leti



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1933-34 razširil Jože Plečnik z novo cerkvijo sv. Cirila in Metoda. Skupaj sta predstavljali enega najlepših dialogov med starim in novim v Ljubljani. Že l. 1954 so določili baročni del cerkve podreti, Plečnikovega pa prenesti oz. ponovno zgraditi po Plečnikovih načrtih na novi lokaciji, nekoliko severneje za Bežigradom. Območje Gospodarskega razstavišča kot prvega velesejemskega kompleksa v Jugoslaviji je bilo namreč izbrano za sedež VII. kongresa Zveze komunistov Jugoslavije. Nova cerkev sv. Cirila in Metoda je bila posvečena l. 1958. Naključje je hotelo, da je Plečnik prav v tem času, l. 1957, umrl. Skoraj deset let po Plečnikovi smrti, med leti 1964-66, je cerkveni ladji dodal monumentalni zvonik Plečnikov učenec Tone Bitenc, ki je svojo arhitekturno kariero posvetil dialogu med starim in novim. Ta zgodba kaže, da je tudi preplet radikalnih in kontekstualnih praks možen, čeprav absurden, saj je v tem primeru banalno izigran prav kontekst sakralnega *locusa* oz. kontekstualnost Plečnikovih prizadevanj.

5 Tone Bitenc: zvonik cerkve sv. Cirila in Metoda, Ljubljana, Bežigrad, 1964-66

6 Plečnik/Bitenc: napis na vratih v zvonik cerkve sv. Cirila in Metoda

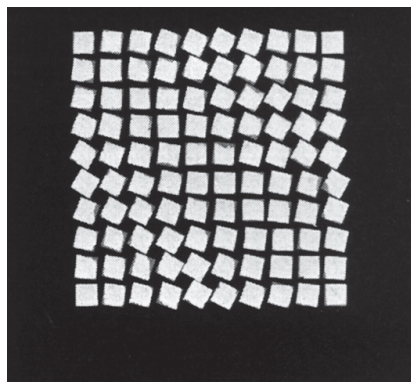
Curiously, the first record of the word "Modern" dates back to 494 AD, when the words "modernus pontifex" were written in relation to the inauguration of Pope Galesius I.¹ Plečnik's approach to church-space design was radically new, as demonstrated by the approval of some of his early-20th century innovations (the horizontal nave) by the Second Vatican Council in 1962. This contributed to the decision that the only works by Plečnik, apart from the National and University Library, included in this selection of Slovenian architecture would be churches, for he would otherwise absolutely surpass other Slovenian architects with his volume of work.

Perhaps the most absurd example of radical action in this country is the fate of St. Christopher's church in Ljubljana. In the Bežigrad district, at the current site of the Ljubljana Trade Fairground – or the Jurček Pavilion to be exact – a small gothic graveyard church once stood, which was said to have been enlarged and baroqueised by the most famous Slovenian baroque architect, Gregor Maček,

in 1708. Due to lack of space, Jože Plečnik later expanded the church between 1933 and 1934, by erecting the church of St. Cyril and St. Methodius. Together, the two churches represented one of Ljubljana's most beautiful dialogues between the old and the new. However, in 1954 that the baroque part of the church was ordered demolished, while Plečnik's part was transferred/rebuilt, according to his own plans, at a new location in the north of the district. The area of the Ljubljana Trade Fairground, as the first exhibition complex in Yugoslavia, had been chosen as the site of the Seventh Communist League of Yugoslavia Congress. The new St. Cyril and St. Methodius church was consecrated in 1958. Fate had it that Jože Plečnik passed away at that very time, in 1957. Almost a decade after his death, between 1964-66, a monumental bell tower was added to the nave by Plečnik's student Tone Bitenc, who later dedicated his architectural career to that very dialogue between the old and the new. This story shows how the intertwining of radical and contextual practice is possible, albeit absurd, as in this case the very context of the holy place and the contextuality of Plečnik's endeavours were played out most banally.

- 7 Edvard Ravnikar: stolpnica na Štefanovi ulici v Ljubljani, 1958-60
 8 Kompozicijska vaja z Ravnikarjeve B-smeri študija arhitekture, 1960

Med radikalnimi praksami naj omenim še drzno urbanistično postavitev stanovanjske stolpnice na Štefanovi ulici v Ljubljani Edvarda Ravnikarja z začetka 60. let. V klasicistično okolje strnjene robne zazidave, na vogal kareja, je Ravnikar diagonalno postavil moderno stanovanjsko stolpnico, ki radikalno, kot izgredek v uglajenem mestnem predelu, ne krši le karejske zazidave, ampak tudi vertikalno silhueto. Zlom simetrije je v evoluciji povezan tudi z razvojem vrst, o čemer je v svoji beležnici »O transmutaciji vrst« pisal že Darwin. Diagonala je eden najprepoznavnejših znakov Ravnikarjeve ustvarjalne dinamike in njegove freigeistovske drže v slovenski arhitekturi, ki jo danes obravnavamo kot klasični modernizem prav zato, ker si je upal v svojem času biti radikalno moderen. V tem duhu je tudi učil. Leta 1960 je po vzoru Bauhauusa ustanovil B-smer študija arhitekture na Fakulteti za arhitekturo v Ljubljani, ki pa je bila zaradi nasprotovanja znotraj same šole po dveh letih ukinjena. Ravnikarjeva učna metoda je temeljila na eksperimentu. Iz te smeri so izšli prvi industrijski oblikovalci pri nas.



Pojem »moderen« ima v primeru »radikalnih praks« prve polovice 20. stoletja, z izjemo primerov Plečnika in Ravnikarja, izrazito efemeran, celo rušilen značaj, saj je vezan na drzno družbeno-politično in kulturno akcijo, utopijo, mladost, potovanja, hitrost, povzdigovanje strojne estetike in zamenljivosti, minljivosti, na zanikanje avtoritete, zanikanje tradicije in dekonstrukcijo. To dobro predstavijo tudi Delakove besede: »Treba je ustvarjati. Ne iz starega novo. Raje nič. Borba. Volja. Vztrajnost.« Značilno za te prakse je tudi, da niso avtohtone, ampak imajo izrazito srednjeevropski značaj, saj gre za prenose futurizma, konstruktivizma in idej Bauhauusa. Za sabo večinoma niso pustile grajene arhitekture, saj tudi prvi predstavniki niso bili šolani arhitekti. Pogost je tudi prelom s tradicijo in linearno dožemanje koncepta časa. V primeru varovanja gre v večini primerov za arhiviranje misli, konceptov, dogodkov, le v redkih primerih za vzpostavljajanje nove tradicije (Plečnik, Ravnikar). S svojim pedagoškim delom je Avgust Černigoj vplival na delo prvih slovenskih funkcionalističnih arhitektov: Rada Kregarja, Jožeta Mesarja in Iva Spinčiča, slednja dva oba učenca Petra Behrensa. V 80. in 90. letih je Černigojevo vlogo nadgradil slovenski umetnik Dragan Živadinov.

Also noteworthy as an example of radical practice is the daring urban planning setting of the block on Štefanova street in Ljubljana by Edvard Ravnikar from the early 60s. Ravnikar diagonally placed a Modernist high-rise on the corner of a classicist block unit, which, like a riot within a refined area, does not only radically violate the block unit, but also the vertical silhouette. A break in symmetry can be evolutionarily linked to the origin of species, as already noted by Darwin in his notebook on the transmutation of species. The diagonal is one of the most distinct features of Ravnikar's creative dynamics and his "freigeist" stance within Slovenian architecture, which we today treat as classical Modernism, above all because Ravnikar dared to be radically modern in his own time. He also taught in this spirit. Inspired by the Bauhaus, he founded an alternative, B-course of architecture at the Faculty of Architecture in Ljubljana (1960), which was cancelled after two years due to opposition from within the faculty. Ravnikar's teaching method was based on experiment. From this course rose the first industrial designers in Slovenia.

The idea of the "Modern", as part of Radical practices from the first half of the 20th century, carries an explicitly ephemeral, even destructive connotation, as it is linked with daring socio-political and cultural action, utopia, youth, travelling, speed, glorification of the machine aesthetic and replaceability, transience, denial of authority and tradition, as well as deconstruction. This has been well expressed by Delak: "It is essential to create. Not from the old. Better to create nothing at all then. Fight. Will. Perseverance." Also typical of these practices is that they are not autochthonous but of clearly mid-European character, as they are mostly transfers of Futurism, Constructivism and Bauhaus practices. These movements left little actual constructed architecture behind them, as their trailblazers were not schooled architects themselves. Also typical are ideas of breaking away from the traditional, and perceiving the concept of time as linear. The conservationist aspect here is related mostly to archiving thought, concepts and events, and only occasionally with establishing new traditions (Plečnik, Ravnikar). With his pedagogical work, Avgust Černigoj influenced the work of Slovenia's first Functionalist architects: Rado Kregar, Jože Mesar and Ivo Spinčič, with the latter two students of Peter Behrens as well. In the 80s and 90s, Černigoj's role was reappraised and upgraded by the Slovenian artist Dragan Živadinov.

Socialne prakse

Relativno visoka stopnja socialne ozaveščenosti v razvoju slovenske arhitekture 20. stoletja je povezana z dejstvom, da velika večina slovenskega prebivalstva v začetku stoletja izhaja iz podeželja, za katerega je značilen kolektivni način dela in soodvisnost. Prva svetovna vojna, ustanavljanje prvih industrijskih obratov, razcvet slovenskega meščanstva, naraščanje delavskega razreda in naraščajoča gospodarska kriza so dogodki, ki so usmerjali arhitektovo misel v smeri postavljanja prvih meščanskih modernističnih vil ter reševanja problemov množične stanovanjske gradnje v mestih, v prvih treh desetletjih 20. stoletja. Pariško razstavo dekorativnih umetnosti l. 1925 so, v organizaciji Franceta Tomažiča, obiskali tudi nekateri slovenski študenti arhitekture in je močno vplivala na popularizacijo moderne arhitekture pri nas. Istega leta je na ljubljanski šoli za arhitekturo organiziral svoj seminar tudi Ivan Vurnik in okoli sebe zbral nekaj nekdanjih Plečnikovih študentov: Burgerja, Omahna, Serajnika in Husa, ki so kasneje postali glavni protagonisti funkcionalistične arhitekture pri nas.

Pri reševanju problemov množične stanovanjske gradnje so se slovenski arhitekti v prvotnem obdobju zgledovali po angleškem modelu vrtnega mesta, po dunajskih in nizozemskih rešitvah ter konceptih, ki jih je ponujal Neue Sachlichkeit v Nemčiji. Značilno za slovensko stanovanjsko gradnjo v drugi polovici 20. in v 30. letih prejšnjega stoletja je, da v svojih začetkih navzven posnema funkcionalistično arhitekturo z gladkimi fasadami brez ornamenta, ravnimi strehami, prizadeva si za čim boljše osvetlitev prostorov in v posameznih primerih uvaja tehnične novosti, kot so dvigala in centralna kurjava, v konstrukcijskem smislu pa gre v večini primerov še vedno za klasično gradnjo, kar je povezano tudi s tlorisnim konceptom. Sem sodijo vile in blok na Vrtači Josipa Costaperarie in Mali nebotičnik Hermana Husa. V delih Franceta Tomažiča in Vladimira Šubica z začetka 30. let govorimo o prvi pravi skeletni armiranobetonski stanovanjski gradnji, z visoko protipotresno zaščito (Nebotičnik, Fakulteta za metalurgijo). Poleg strnjene robne zazidave stanovanj se v 30. letih pojavljajo tudi prvi primeri prosto stoječe stanovanjske gradnje blokov v samem centru mesta (Dukićevi bloki arhitekta Jožeta Sivca).

Ivan Vurnik, sicer eden od ustanoviteljev ljubljanske šole za arhitekturo, se je l. 1926 udeležil mednarodnega kongresa za stanovanja in urbanizem (*Internationaler Wohnungs und Städtebaukongress*), ki ga je na Dunaju organizirala socialdemokratska mestna oblast. Na kongresu, ki se ga je udeležil tudi Raymond Unwin, sta se spopadli progresistična in romantična struja; prva je zagovarjala gradnjo velikih stanovanjskih naselij po vzoru dunajskih »Höfe«, druga pa gradnjo vrtnih mest. Med leti 1926-27 je prav po vzoru dunajskih »Höfe« zrasla ljubljanska Meksika, prvi obsežni socialni stanovanjski kompleks v Ljubljani, arhitekta Vladimirja Šubica. Vurnik se je, nasprotno, oprijel ideje vrtnega mesta in med leti 1927-29 sprojeval delavsko naselje vrstnih hiš v Mariboru, za katerega je z izračuni tudi dokazal, da je ekonomsko bolj upravičen od Meksike. Na prvo mesto je postavil zahtevo po ekonomičnosti in

Social Practices

The relatively high level of social awareness in the development of 20th-century Slovenian architecture is related to the fact that the majority of the Slovenian population at the beginning of the century had roots in the countryside, of which collective work and co-dependency are rather typical. The First World War, the first industrial plants, the flourishing of the Slovenian urban population, the growth of the working class and the intensifying economic crisis all helped direct architects' minds towards constructing the first urban Modernist villas and towards solving the problems of mass housing within cities during the first three decades of the 20th century. In this spirit, the Parisian exhibition of decorative arts in 1925 was also visited by a number of Slovenian architectural students under the direction of France Tomažič; the exhibition strongly influenced the popularisation of Modernist architecture in Slovenia. In the same year, Ivan Vurnik formed his own seminar group at the Ljubljana School of Architecture, assembling former students of Plečnik – Burger, Omahen, Serajnik and Hus – who would later become the main protagonists of Slovenian Functionalist architecture.

To help solve the problem of mass housing, Slovenian architects turned to the British model of the Garden City, and to Viennese and Dutch solutions, along with the concepts of the German "Neue Sachlichkeit". Characteristic of Slovenian residential architecture from the second half of the 20s, and the 30s, is that it copies the exterior of Functionalist architecture and its rational facades without ornaments, flat roofs, striving for quality space lighting, and occasionally introducing technical novelties such as elevators and central heating. In terms of construction, however, these buildings are still classical constructions, which is also linked to the floor-plan concept. Examples of architecture of this kind are the villas and the block at Vrtača by Josip Costaperaria, and the Little Scyscarper by Herman Hus. The work of France Tomažič and Vladimir Šubic includes the first true skeleton-frame reinforced-concrete residential architecture with high anti-seismic protection (The Skyscraper, Faculty for Metalurgy). Besides the block units, the 30s saw the first construction of free-standing residential buildings in the city centre (the Dukić blocks by Jože Sivec).

In 1926, Ivan Vurnik, one of the founders of the Ljubljana School of Architecture, attended the International Housing and Town Planning Congress (*Internationaler Wohnungs und Städtebaukongress*), organised in Vienna by the social-democratic city authorities. At the congress, which was also attended by Raymond Unwin, a clash between the progressive and the romanticist movement took place; the first in favour of large residential areas in the manner of Viennese "Höfe", the second of constructing Garden Cities. Between 1926 and 1927, Meksika, the first large social housing in Ljubljana, was constructed, based on the aforementioned "Höfe"; the building was designed by Šubic. Vurnik, on the other hand, turned to the idea of a Garden City and designed a series of terraced houses for workers in Maribor, which proved to be economically much more justifiable than Meksika. He saw rational use of space and economy as the top pri-

9 Vladimir Šubic: Meksika, glavna fasada, 1926-27, iz zapuščine Ivana in Mirka Šubica, MAO, foto: Hugon Hibšer

10 Vladimir Šubic: Meksika, dvorišče, 1926-27, iz zapuščine Ivana in Mirka Šubica, MAO, foto: Hugon Hibšer

11 Rado Kregar: revija Arhitektura, 1931-34

racionalni izrabi prostora. Okrožni urad za zavarovanje delavcev je dal posojilo z nizkimi obrestmi, mariborska mestna občina je pokrila komunalne stroške in zastoj vodila nadzorna in organizacijska dela, posojilojemalci pa so po dvajsetih letih odplačevanja, v obliki mesečnih najemnin, postali lastniki svojih domov.²



Leta 1930 so nekateri mladi slovenski arhitekti ustanovili Klub arhitektov in vzpostavili zveze z zagrebškimi in beograjskimi kolegi. Že naslednje leto so organizirali prvo razstavo sodobne jugoslovanske arhitekture v Beogradu. Sočasno je arhitekt Rado Kregar izdal prvo številko revije Arhitektura, ki je izhajala do l. 1934. Poleg revije so začele izhajati posamezne specializirane publikacije, ki so predstavljale moderne koncepte bivanja; Leta 1931 sta Ivo Spinčič in Jože Mesar izdala knjigo Stanovanje, leta 1934 pa Rado Kregar še Naš dom. Namen teh publikacij je bil popularizirati sodoben način bivanja med strokovno in laično javnostjo. Med številnimi razstavami, ki so jih organizirali, je bila najpomembnejša l. 1933 v Jakopičevem paviljonu, z uvodnim nagovorom Franceta Tomažiča v prid moderni, funkcionalistični arhitekturi.³

Druga svetovna vojna je pomenila za Slovenijo, takrat del nove Jugoslavije, popoln družbenopolitični in gospodarski preobrat, ki ga v prvem obdobju označujeta izgradnja socializma in filozofsko ozadje dialektičnega materializma. Država se je skozi arhitekturo vzpostavljala. Vera v boljši jutri je dejansko imela moč religije. Arhitektom je uspelo ohraniti zavidljivo stopnjo avtonomnosti in hkrati slediti splošnim družbenim ciljem, ki so bili tipično socialistični. Privatna praksa zaradi družbenopolitične ureditve ni bila mogoča, zato so v ospredje prihajale velike projektantske organizacije kot npr. Slovenijaprojekt. Prvotni obnovi v vojni porušene domovine je sledila izgradnja industrije in s tem povezanih prvih delavskih naselij, ki so nastajala po sistemu prostostojećih blokov v heliotermični osi. Industrija je postala glasnica novih gradbenih hotenj. Zaradi potreb po čim hitrejši in čim cenejši gradnji stanovanj je arhitekt Danilo Fürst razvil sistem Hitrogradnja, ki je prvi korak k montažni stanovanjski gradnji pri nas. Fürst je tudi avtor prve popolnoma montažne hiše pri nas, ki je bila zgrajena v osmih dneh s celotno notranjo opremo.

orities. The Workers' District Office provided low-interest loans, while the Maribor municipality covered the communal expenses and took charge of supervision and organisation free of charge; after 20 years of paying off loans in the form of monthly rent, the tenants became the owners of their homes.²

In 1930 a group of young Slovenian architects founded the Architects' Club and established links with their colleagues in Zagreb and Belgrade. The following year, they organised the first exhibition of contemporary Yugoslav architecture in Belgrade. At the same time, architect Rado Kregar published the first issue of Arhitektura magazine, which ran until 1934. Besides the magazine, specialised publications surfaced, presenting modern concepts of living. In 1931, Ivo Spinčič and Jože Mesar published a book called Stanovanje (Apartment), which was followed by Rado Kregar's Naš Dom (Our Home) in 1934. The purpose of these publications was to popularise a contemporary way of life with both the profession and the public. Among numerous exhibitions organised, the most important was held in the Jakopič Pavilion in 1933, with France Tomažič's opening speech defending Modernist, Functionalist architecture.³

The Second World War presented a complete socio-political and economical transition for Slovenia (then a part of the newly formed Yugoslavia). This transition was, at the start, marked mostly by socialism and the philosophical background of dialectical materialism. The country was establishing itself through architecture. The faith in a better tomorrow did indeed have the power of religion. Architects managed to both sustain an enviable degree of autonomy and at the same time follow general social goals, the latter being typically socialist. Due to the socio-political order of the day, private practice was not an option, and therefore large project-engineering organisations such as Slovenijaprojekt became more prominent. The first restoration of a war-stricken homeland was followed by the setting up of industry and accompanying workers' housing that grew as free-standing blocks on a heliothermic axis. Industry became the source of new trends in the field of construction. In response to the need for a faster and cheaper way of building apartments, architect Danilo Fürst developed the "Hitrogradnja" ("Fast Construction") system, which was the first step towards prefabricated construction in Slovenia. Fürst was also responsible for the first completely prefabricated building in Slovenia, which was constructed in eight days, including the interior.

12 Danilo Fürst: prva montažna hiša na območju nekdanje Jugoslavije, Ljubljana, 1946

13 Edvard Ravnikar: urbanistični načrt Nove Gorice, maketa, 1947

14 Janez Trenz, Franc Šmid, Ciril Pogačnik: urbanistični načrt Velenja, 1947

15 Danilo Fürst: realiziran del urbanističnega načrta Kidričevo, 1947-1949



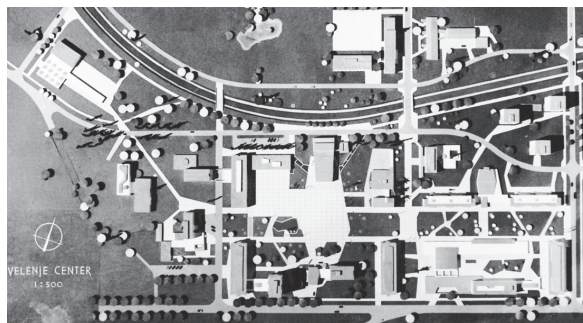
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V ta čas sodi tudi izgradnja prvih novih mest pri nas: Nove Gorice, Velenja in Kidričevega. Osnova našega povojnega urbanizma so bila priporočila CIAM-a in Le Corbusierova urbanistična doktrina, zapisana v Atenski listini (La Ville radieuse, 1935). Ta projekt je bil tudi zgled pri Ravnikarjevi zasnovi našega prvega povsem novega mesta - Nove Gorice (1947), ki je zasnovana na sistemu cestnega križa z razdelitvijo osnovnih mestnih funkcij. Po težki pridobitvi slovenskega Primorja in izgubi Gorice se je arhitekturno urbanistična zasnova Nove Gorice izkazala kot neke vrste »orožje« v nacionalnem in političnem boju. »Takratni polet je bil napolnjen s patosom velike zgodovinske spremembe v urbanizmu in arhitekturi, kot alternativa z vojno in oboroževanjem ... Zgradili naj bi nekaj velikega, lepega in ponosnega, nekaj, kar bi sijalo prek meje.«⁴ Velikopotezni mestni načrt se je, značilno za naše takratne razmere, izkazal kot precenitev zmognosti. Od celotnega programa je bilo realizirano le južno stanovanjsko naselje. Podobno usodo je doživelo Kidričevo (1947-49) arhitekta Danila Fürsta; od ambicioznega prvotnega načrta popolnoma novega mesta aksialne zasnove, z bolnico, hotelom, kulturnim središčem, šolo, upravnim in gospodarskim ter rekreacijskim centrom, sredi borovega gozda, na ozemlju 2 x 2 km, je bilo realiziranih le 8 stanovanjskih blokov in restavracija. Tretje naše novo mesto, Velenje, je formirano okrog monumentalnega centralnega trga, ki predstavlja kulturno, upravno in politično središče mesta. Urbanizem Velenja so zasnovali: Janez Trenz, Franc Šmid in Ciril Pogačnik, urbanizem osrednjega trga (Titov trg) pa Paul Karl Filipsky in Kurt Zöhrer.

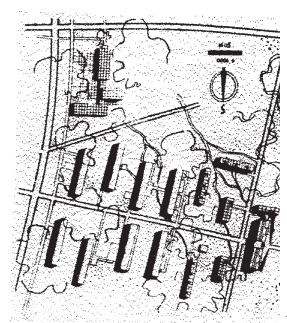
This was also the time of the first new towns in Slovenia: Nova Gorica, Velenje and Kidričevo. Our post-war urban planning was based on recommendations by CIAM and on Le Corbusier's doctrine, as documented in the Athens Charter (La Ville radieuse, 1935). This project also served as an exemplar for Ravnikar's plans for our first entirely new city – Nova Gorica (1947), conceived as a cross section of the main roads, dividing the basic city functions. After the hard-won acquisition of the Littoral, and losing Gorica, the urban planning conception of Nova Gorica was a kind of "weapon" in the national and political battle. "That flight was filled with the pathos of a great historical change within urban planning and architecture, alternating with war and armament ... We were supposed to build something great, beautiful and proud, something that would radiate across the border."⁴ The large-scale city plan, typically for the time, turned out to have been a miscalculation of the ability. The only thing actually realised was six blocks of residential housing. Kidričevo (1947-49), by architect Danilo Fürst, was in for the same fate; the only realised part of the ambitious original plans for a new, axially conceived city, to include a hospital, a hotel, a cultural centre, a school, an administrative, economic and recreational centre, situated in a pinewood area of 2 x 2 sqm, was the construction of eight residential buildings and a restaurant. Our third new city, Velenje, is formed around a monumental central square, which represents the cultural, administrative and political city centre. The urban planning for Velenje was conceived by Janez Trenz, Franc Šmid and Ciril Pogačnik, while the planning for the central square (Titov trg) was carried out by Paul Karl Filipsky and Kurt Zöhrer.



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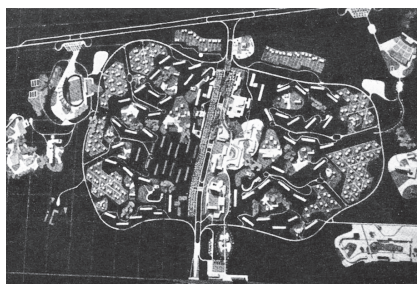


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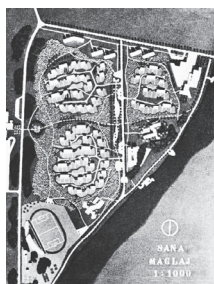
- 16 Edvard Ravnikar: urbanistična zasnova Strnišča, 1950
 17 Edvard Ravnikar: urbanistična zasnova Maglaja, maketa, 1952
 18 Edvard Ravnikar: urbanistična zasnova Maglaja, skica, 1952
 19 Edvard Ravnikar: urbanistična zasnova Kranja, 1951
 20 Edvard Ravnikar: naslovnica revije Arhitekt, 1956

Po izkušnji z Novo Gorico se je Ravnikar ob razstavi arhitekture FLRJ leta 1951, v nasprotju z gradnjo novih idealnih mest, zavzel za regulacijo že obstoječih živih organizmov.⁵ Predlagal je gradnjo urejenih kompleksov enodružinskih hiš v obstoječih naseljih vzdolž pomembnih prometnih zvez, podobno kot Le Corbusier leta 1944 v delu »Les trois établissements humains«.

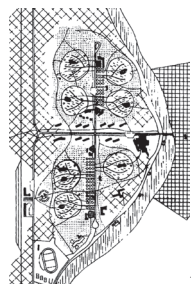
After the Nova Gorica period, Ravnikar made a stand for development of already existing, living organisms,⁵ as opposed to building new, ideal cities. At the FLRJ (Federal People's Republic of Yugoslavia) architecture exhibition in 1951, he proposed the construction of cluster housing in existing settlements along important traffic connections, inspired by Le Corbusier's suggestion in his *Les trois établissements humains* (1944).



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V referatu za prvi kongres Zveze arhitektov Jugoslavije leta 1950 v Dubrovniku se Ravnikar, ki ga štejemo za pionirja sodobnega slovenskega urbanizma, zavzame za policentrično urbanizacijo Slovenije z utemeljitvijo, da v Sloveniji še ne moremo govoriti o mestu in deželi kot o dveh nasprotujočih si principih ter da zaradi razmeroma enotne stopnje razvitosti, rast naših mest ni koncentrična, ampak paralelna, kar omogoča tudi dobra prometna mreža, ki jo ima Slovenija kot izrazito prehodno ozemlje. »Če se morajo manj razvite dežele (kot npr. kolonije) dvigati na točkah, imajo bolj razvite možnosti istočasnega splošnega dviganja.«⁶ Kljub temu da se je teorija o policentrični urbanizaciji Slovenije ujemala z našo tedanjo politiko odpravljanja razlik med mestom in vasjo, je bilo dejansko stanje drugačno. Največja napaka je bila gotovo zanemarjanje prometnih povezav, v čemer je Ravnikar videl osnovni pogoj za uspešen policentričen razvoj Slovenije.

Za razvoj urbanizma je bila pomembna tudi razstava z naslovom »Porodica i domačinstvo« leta 1958 v Zagrebu, kjer je Slovenija predstavila model idealne stanovanjske soseske »Stambena zajednica« za 5000 prebivalcev. Ta model je rezultat študija soseske po švedskem vzoru v seminarju Edvarda Ravnikarja. Stanovanjsko naselje obkroža lokalna cesta, ki se v obliki črke Y navezuje na glavno cesto. Med glavno cesto in stanovanjskim predelom je »središče stambene zajednice«, sledijo višji večstanovanjski objekti, ki nato postopoma preidejo v sklop enodružinskih hiš. Šolski in športni center sta locirana desno, izven cestnega obroča, ki obkroža naselje. S tem se je odprla pot razmišljanju za vsestransko zadovoljitev potreb v naselitveni enoti pri nas, kar je bila leta 1953 tudi tema IX. kongresa CIAM.⁷

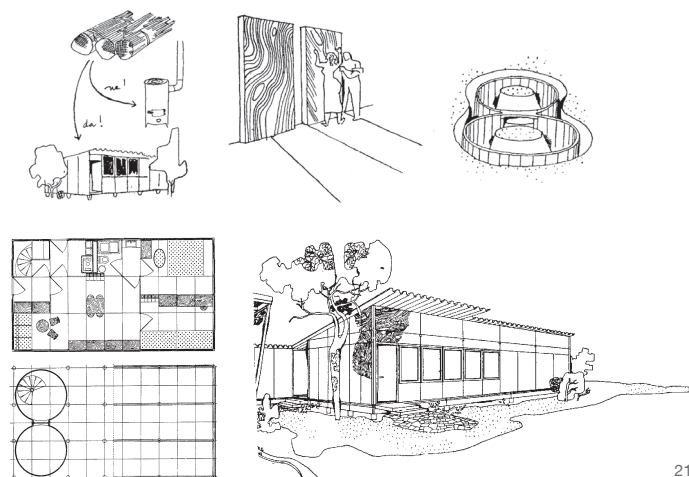
Ljudska skupščina FLRJ je leta 1959 sprejela Zakon o stanovanjski skupnosti, po katerem naj bi se ustanovljale stanovanjske skupnosti, ki pomenijo zaključeno urbanistično celoto (soseske). Leta 1952 so bili ustanovljeni stanovanjski skladi, ki naj bi prispevali k boljši gradbeni politiki stanovanj. Sredi 50. let se je pri nas uveljavljala zadružna

In his report for the first Yugoslavian Architects' Association congress in 1950 in Dubrovnik, Ravnikar – a pioneer of modern Slovenian urban planning – defended the idea of a polycentric urbanisation of Slovenia, justifying it with the fact that it was still hard to draw a line in Slovenia between the city and the country as two opposing principles and because the relatively unified development level made the growth of our cities not concentric, but parallel. This was also enabled by the quality of the country's traffic grid, Slovenia having immensely passable terrain. "If less-developed countries (such as colonies, for instance) need to rise at certain points, those that are more developed have the chance of rising evenly all over."⁶ Even though the theory on polycentric urbanisation of Slovenia matched well with the political drive of the time to eliminate differences between cities and villages, the state of affairs was indeed different. The gravest mistake was the negligence of traffic connections; in these connections, Ravnikar saw the basic prerequisite for Slovenia's successful polycentric development.

Another major factor in the development of urban planning was the 1958 exhibition "Porodica i domačinstvo" (Family and Household), held in Zagreb. There, Slovenia introduced a model of the ideal residential community – "Stambena zajednica" – for 5,000 inhabitants. This model was the result of neighbourhood studies learning from Swedish examples as part of Edvard Ravnikar's seminar. The community in this model is surrounded by a local road that connects with the main road in a Y-shaped form. Between the main road and the residential area is the centre of the community, followed by taller apartment buildings, which gradually fuse into a series of single-family houses. The school and sports centres are located on the right, outside of the ring road surrounding the housing estate. This model led to contemplation of how general needs in a settlement unit could be fulfilled; this was also the topic of the ninth CIAM congress in 1953.⁷ In 1959, the Federal Assembly of FLRJ passed the Housing Community Law, which called for the establishment of housing com-

gradnja vrstnih hiš, do katere je pripeljala ugotovitev, da le dobro organizirana stanovanjska gradnja, podprta z najširšo publiciteto, lahko omogoči res racionalno porabo sredstev, ki so določena v ta namen. Splošna ugotovitev, da je vrstna hiša zelo primeren način združne stanovanjske gradnje, saj predstavlja kvalitetno rešitev v primerjavi s kaotično obmestno gradnjo in hkrati omogoča večjo identiteto kot blokovna gradnja, je pripeljala arhitekta Društva arhitektov Slovenije do realizacij lastnih združnih vrstnih hiš.⁸ Med prvimi so bile zgrajene združne vrstne hiše na Mirju (1955-57) arhitekta Marka Šlajmerja in v Šiški (1955-56) arhitekta Otona Jugovca, vrstne hiše tekstilne tovarne v Novem mestu (1955) arhitekta Miloša Lapajneteta ter vrstne hiše projektivnega biroja Komuna projekt v Mariboru (1955-56) arhitektov Branka Kocmuta in Bogomirja Ungarja.

Čeprav je bila gradnja enodružinskih hiš v tem času nenačrtna in stihijna, je v okviru Ravnikarjevega seminarja nastala vrsta kvalitetnih projektov individualne gradnje. Morda najzanimivejši je primer Montažne hiše iz lesenih odpadkov iz leta 1952, ki kot glavni gradbeni material uporablja žamanje z žag. Uvaja tudi več novih tehnoloških postopkov izdelave posameznih elementov ter nov sistem elektroinstalacije in gretja. Montažna klet je sestavljena iz betonskih elementov po principu gradnje soda, kar narekuje minimalen izkop. Zanimive so tudi rešitve natečaja za lesene montažne hiše, ki ga je s pomočjo Društva arhitektov Slovenije leta 1954 razpisalo Lesno industrijsko podjetje v Kranju, ki je nudil možnost uveljavitve takrat mlajšim projektantom.



21

Pomembni dogodki, ki so poleg ustanovitve Društva arhitektov Slovenije v 50. letih znanomovali razvoj arhitekturne stroke, so: ustanovitev revije Arhitekt, organizacija simpozija »Od stare k novi šoli« in razstave »Stanovanje za naše razmere«.

Revija Arhitekt je izhajala med leti 1951-63 in je obravnavala tekoče dogodke s področja arhitekture, urbanizma in oblikovanja. Prvih sedem števil Arhitekta (1951-52) si je prizadevalo za priznanje arhitekta in arhitekture kot stroke v družbenem življenju s pestrim in širokim prikazom arhitekturnega dela. Naslovnico teh prvih števil

21 E. Ravnikar, M. Šlajmer, M. Lapajne: Montažna hiša iz lesenih odpadkov, 1952

22 Oton Jugovec: montažne počitniške hišice v Ankaranu, 1957-58

munities that would form urban units (neighbourhoods). In 1952, housing funds were set aside to contribute to better housing policies. In the mid-50s, building terraced houses through a building cooperative came to prominence, as it had been proved that only well-organised housing, backed with widespread publicity, could really enable rational use of the means planned for this purpose. The general observation that a terraced house is the most suitable form for cooperative building – as it introduces a higher quality solution, compared with chaotic peripheral housing, and as it at the same time allows greater expression of identity than apartment blocks – brought the architects of the Slovenian Architects' Association to develop their own terraced houses built through cooperation.⁸ Among the first such houses to be built were those on Mirje (1955-57), by architect Marko Šlajmer, and in Šiška (1955-56) by Oton Jugovec, the terraced houses of the textile plant in Novo mesto (1955) by Miloš Lapajne, and those of the "Komuna projekt" bureau in Maribor (1955-57) by Branko Kocmut and Bogomir Ungar.

Despite the fact that the construction of single-family houses was unplanned and uncontrolled, Ravnikar's seminar spawned a series of high-quality individual housing projects. Perhaps the most interesting example is the Prefabricated House of Wooden Debris of 1952, which used residual wood from sawing as the main material. It also introduced various new technologies used to manufacture individual elements and a new system of electrical installation and heating. The prefabricated basement was of concrete elements constructed like a barrel, requiring minimal excavation. Also interesting are the contributions to a publication on the construction of a wooden prefabricated house, which was sent out in 1954 by Lesno industrijsko podjetje from Kranj, aided by the Slovenian Architects' Association; this publication also provided many younger architects with the chance to establish themselves.



22

Other important events besides the founding of the Slovenian Architects' Association in the 50s were: the Arhitekt magazine, the symposium "From the Old Towards the New School" and the exhibition "An Apartment for Our Circumstances".

Arhitekt magazine ran from 1951 to 1963, and covered events in architecture, urban planning and design. The first seven issues (1951-52) focused on the acknowledgement of architects and architecture as a part of social life, displaying a wide and colourful array of architectural works. The cover for these first issues was

23 Organizatorji simpozija »Od stare k novi šoli«: z leve: Danilo Fürst, Alfred Roth, Edvard Ravnikar, Boris Gaberščik, France Ivanšek, Oton Gaspari in Niko Bežek na železniški postaji v Ljubljani, 1954

24 Danilo Fürst: realiziran natečajni projekt OŠ Stražišče pri Kranju, 1954

je oblikoval Edvard Ravnikar in pomeni začetek novega obdobja v grafičnem oblikovanju v Sloveniji.⁹

Leta 1954 je bilo v Ljubljani posvetovanje arhitektov, pedagogov in zdravnikov o prednostih novega načina izobraževanja z naslovom »Od stare k novi šoli«. Posvetovanje je spremljala razstava sodobnih šolskih zgradb, ob tej priložnosti pa je bil razpisan tudi natečaj za novo šolo. Posvetovanja se je udeležil tudi eden najpomembnejših teoretikov in praktikov sodobne šole v tistem času, švicarski arhitekt Alfred Roth.



23

designed by Edvard Ravnikar; its conception marked the beginning of a new era of graphic design in Slovenia.⁹

In 1954, a symposium called "From the Old Towards the New School" was held in Ljubljana, at which architects, pedagogues and academics discussed the advantages of a new mode of education. The symposium was accompanied by an exhibition and a call for applications for contemporary school buildings. The symposium was attended by Swiss architect Alfred Roth, one of the most important theoreticians and practitioners of the time.



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Zahteve po spremembi načina izobraževanja so bile tedaj splošno prisotne in izpostavljene tudi na VIII. kongresu CIAM-a v Hoddesdonu v Angliji.¹⁰ Za razliko od stare, klasične in toge zasnove šole naj bi bila nova bolj razgibana in naj bi omogočila tudi ustrežnejše oblikovanje šolskega okolja. Skupno je bilo spoznanje, da je otrok središče šolske vzgoje in oblikovanja šolske zgradbe. Poudarjal se je pomen stika z naravo in pomen svetlobe. Stari sistem nerazčlenjenega večetažnega šolskega bloka se je umaknil pritlični paviljonski zgradbi in enonadstropni zgradbi s centralnim prostorom med razredi, kar omogoča uvedbo dvostranske osvetlitve. Nova načela individualne vzgoje v šolah po svetu in čim večja sproščenost v oblikovanju pouka sta zahtevala razred novih dimenzij. Starejša, pravokotna oblika razreda se je približala kvadratu. Rezultat natečaja je OŠ Stražišče arhitekta Danila Fürsta, ki je postala vzor za sodobno šolsko zgradbo na območju Jugoslavije. S šolsko arhitekturo sta se v obravnavanem obdobju intenzivno ukvarjala tudi arhitekta Oton Gaspari in Emil Navinšek. Slednji si je prizadeval vpeljati t. i. brezkoridorski sistem šol z osrednjo avlo in stopniščem, okoli katere so nanizane učilnice. Po tem sistemu so zgradili prek 40 šol po celi Sloveniji.

Leta 1956 je bila postavljena razstava, ki jo je spremljalo posvetovanje »Stanovanje za naše razmere« v takrat še nedograjeni stavbi Kozolec arhitekta Edo Mihevca. »Stanovanje za naše razmere« je bilo prvo vsejugoslovansko posvetovanje o stanovanjski izgradnji, katerega namen je bil pokazati takrat dostopno tehniko, ekonomiko in kulturo ter pridobljene izkušnje na tem področju. Osnovna

Demand for change in the model of education was very much present at the time and was also stressed at the VIII CIAM congress in Hoddesdon, England.¹⁰ In contrast to the old school, classical and rigid, the new school was supposed to be more dynamic, enabling more appropriate forms of school environment. The child was considered the heart of education and of school-building design. The emphasis was on staying in touch with nature, and on the importance of light. The old system of an undivided, multi-storey building had to make way for a new, ground-floor pavilion and a one-storey building, containing a central space between classrooms, to enable light from two sides. New principles of individual education in schools across the globe, and an increasing flexibility in shaping classes, required a classroom of different dimensions. The older, rectangular classroom shape evolved into a square. The final product of the call for applications is Stražišče Primary School by architect Danilo Fürst, which has become an exemplar of a Modernist school building in former Yugoslavia. The two other architects intensively active in the field of school architecture at this time were Oton Gaspari and Emil Navinšek. The latter worked to introduce the corridor-free system, with a central hall and staircase surrounded by classrooms. This system served as a model for over 40 schools around Slovenia.

The 1956 "An Apartment for Our Circumstances" conference was accompanied by an exhibition and took place in the unfinished Kozolec building, designed by Edo Mihevc. The conference was the first of its kind dealing with housing, and aiming to showcase technological, economic and cultural developments, along with experi-

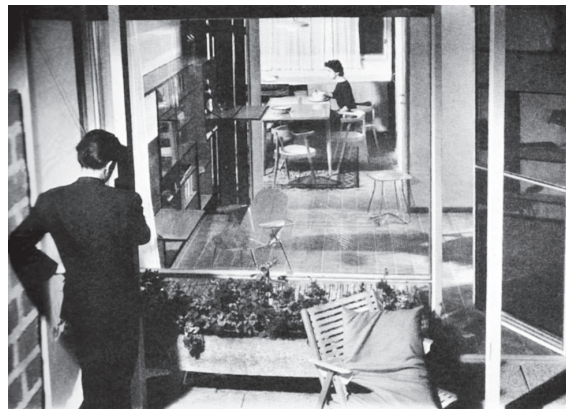
25, 26 Simpozij »Stanovanje za naše razmere«: makete zmagovalnih natečajnih projektov stanovanj z notranjo opremo v merilu 1:1 v stavbi Kozolec v Ljubljani, 1956

misel je bila prehod k industrijskemu načinu gradnje, od industrije gradbenega materiala do opreme stanovanj. Cilj je bil ustvariti stanovanje, ki ustreza našim pogojem, možnostim, sposobnostim in nazorom.¹¹ Razstavljeni so bili tudi rezultati natečaja, ki je bil razpisan ob posvetovanju. Zajemal je tri področja: stanovanje, opremo in sanitarne instalacije. Nekaj maket natečajnih rešitev je bilo predstavljenih v naravni velikosti z vso notranjo opremo. Novost je bila funkcionalna kuhinja Branke Tancig, ostalo opremo pa je oblikoval Niko Kralj. S tem smo dobili prve standardne tipe stanovanj.

ence gained in this field. The basic idea was the transition towards an industrial mode of building, from the building industry to interior design. The goal was to create an apartment to fit the circumstances, possibilities, capabilities and outlook of the time.¹¹ The exhibition displayed the results of the parallel call for applications, comprising three areas: apartments, interior design and sanitary installations. Some models were displayed full scale, along with their interior design. Another innovation was the functional kitchen by Branka Tancig, with Niko Kralj designing the rest of the interior. This was a major source for the first standard apartment types in the country.



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Med vplivi, ki so najbolj zaznamovali razvoj slovenske socialne arhitekture v času po drugi svetovni vojni, gre izpostaviti politični vpliv, od tujih pa vpliv švedske stanovanjske politike in arhitekture. Pozitivna vloga politike je bila, da je v odmaknjenih delavskih naseljih, kot so Trbovlje, Zagorje in Velenje, organizirala gradnjo kulturnih domov, ki so jih takrat imenovali »družbeni centri«. Gradnja teh monumentalnih zgradb, ki so si prav zaradi svoje monumentalnosti prislužile tudi kritiko stroke tistega časa¹², je nudila zaposlitev velikemu številu domačih delavcev in v naslednjih desetletjih ključno pripomogla k dvigu kulturne zavesti delavskega razreda, saj iz teh krajev izhajajo nekatere najprepoznavnejše umetniške skupine, ki so odigrale ključno vlogo na slovenski in mednarodni kulturni sceni v 80. in 90. letih (Laibach).

Na povezanost arhitekture in politike v času po drugi svetovni vojni kaže predvsem vloga arhitekta Eda Mihevca, ki je avtor urbanizma ter večjega dela stanovanjske in turistične arhitekture, ki je v 50. in 60. letih nastajala v slovenskem Primorju.

Za implementacijo švedskih dognanj na področju stanovanjske gradnje pri nas sta najbolj zaslužna arhitekta Ljubo Humek in France Ivanšek. Prvi je po vrnitvi s Švedske ustanovil v Mariboru biro Komunaprojekt, glavno projektantsko organizacijo v tem času na Štajerskem, ki je odločilno prispevala k razvoju stanovanjske in šolske gradnje, predvsem pa je imel Ljubo Humek odločilno vlogo pri urbanističnem oblikovanju mesta Maribor s številnimi trgi in parki. France Ivanšek si je z organizacijo Oddelka za stanovanjsko raziskovanje UI LRS, simpozijev »Barva in oblika« na Fakulteti za arhitekturo, razstav »Pogrnjena miza« ter s prodajnimi saloni v

Among the influences that marked Slovenian social post-war architecture most were the political influence from within, and the external influence of Swedish housing policy and architecture.

The most positive aspect of the policy of the time was that it organised the construction of cultural centres – then called “social centres” – in workers’ settlements such as Trbovlje, Zagorje and Velenje. The construction of these monumental buildings, which were criticised for that very monumentality,¹² supported the hiring of many local workers and helped to raise the cultural awareness of the working class in the following decades. These towns were thus home to some of the most recognisable artistic groups in the Slovenian and international scene of the 80s and 90s (such as Laibach).

The intertwining of architecture and politics after the Second World War is most visible in the role of architect Edo Mihevc, originator of urban planning concepts and of a major part of the apartment and tourist architecture that rose in the Littoral region during the 50s and 60s. The most significant in the implementation of Swedish findings in the area of housing were architects Ljubo Humek and France Ivanšek. On his return from Sweden, the former founded the Komunaprojekt office in Maribor, the main architectural organisation in Štajerska region at the time. The organisation greatly contributed to the development of housing and schools; most significant of all, however, was Humek’s role in the urban planning of Maribor, with its numerous squares and parks. France Ivanšek, who organised the Housing Research Department at the UI LRS, the “Colour and Form” symposiums at the Faculty of Architecture, the “Set Table” exhibition, and design stores in Ljubljana and Maribor, looked to Swedish models

Ljubljani in Mariboru prizadeval za dvig kulture bivanja navadnega človeka v povezavi z domačo industrijo po švedskih vzorih.

Socialna nota v razumevanju besede »moderen« je pri nas dejansko najbolj zaživela v času po drugi svetovni vojni, ko je dobila tudi svojega uradnega zaveznika v politiki. Trideseta leta predstavljajo prve poskuse v tej smeri. Moderna šola, stanovanje in bolnica pomenijo arhitekturo, ki je ekonomična in služi osnovnim funkcijam sodobnega človeka v smislu novega urbanizma, svobodnega tlorisa, industrijske montažne gradnje in večje povezanosti z naravo. Moderen tu ne pomeni več efemeran, minljiv ampak socialno ozaveščen, ekonomičen, funkcionalen, racionalen, minimalen, serijski. Zaradi zahteve po čim večji ekonomičnosti in novih materialih, konstrukcijskih možnostih in serijski proizvodnji, ki jih je gradbeništvo nudila porajajoča se domača industrija, je problematika varovanja te arhitekture vezana predvsem na probleme staranja vidnega betona, slabo izolacijo, toplotne mostove, na uporabo nekaterih materialov, ki jih danes ni več na trgu, ter na minimalne standarde, ki so se danes spremenili. Slovenski modernizem 30. let je vplival na slovenski postmodernizem v 80. letih, modernizem 60. let pa na slovensko arhitekturo poznih 90. in prvo desetletje novega tisočletja.

Kontekstualne prakse

Germanški in francoski vplivi so poleg domačega okolja najbolj zaznamovali razvoj slovenske arhitekturne šole v 20. stoletju. Izhodišče moderne slovenske arhitekture 20. stoletja predstavlja Dunaj. Tam so se šolali Fabiani, Plečnik in Vurnik. Čeprav je bila prva univerza pri nas za krajši čas ustanovljena v času Napoleonovih Ilirskih provinc l. 1810 (Écoles centrales), smo prvo slovensko univerzo dobili šele l. 1919. Ljubljanska arhitekturna šola je bila ustanovljena l. 1920, za kar gre največ zaslug Ivanu Vurniku. Plečnik je na njej potem, ko je zaključil poučevanje na umetniško-obrtni šoli v Pragi, oblikoval svoj seminar l. 1921. Plečnikova šola temelji na srednjeveški tradiciji mojster-vajenec in na Schinkel-Semper-Wagnerjevi teoriji razvoja arhitekture prek obrti. Od tod izvira tudi Plečnikov princip oblačenja stavbe »Bekleidungsprinzip«. ¹³ Študenti so se samostojno seznanjali tudi s Choisijevo knjigo »Histoire de l'architecture«, ki razlaga razvoj forme z razvojem tehnike. Edvard Ravnikar, ki je po končani diplomii pri Plečniku nekaj časa delal pri Le Corbusieru, je po prihodu na šolo po drugi svetovni vojni, l. 1946, nadgradil Plečnikovo tradicijo s francoskimi vplivi. Od Plečnika je zadržal seminarski način dela, obravnavanje detajla, fasade, skrbi za risbo in prezentacijo ter odnos do lokalnega konteksta. Vpliv Le Corbusiera je čutiti v razvoju prostorskega koncepta in armiranobetonske konstrukcije, predvsem pa v razumevanju duha časa in nove družbene vloge, ki jo je ta nalagal arhitektu. Ravnikarjeva učna metoda je temeljila na znanstvenem dvomu, eksperimentu ter analizi in sintezi. To je bila metoda, ki jo je predlagal tudi CIAM. ¹⁴ Pomembno vlogo pri ohranjanju in reinterpretaciji izročila slovenske arhitekturne tradicije in funkcionalnega izročila slovenskega podeželja, tako v pedagoškem kot v teoretičnem in praktičnem smislu, so imeli tudi Ivan Vurnik, Dušan Grabrijan, Marjan Mušič, Anton Bitenc, Oton

to improve the way of life of the ordinary man, linked to Slovenian industry.

The social note to the word "Modern" visibly came alive most clearly after the Second World War, when it won an official ally in the political sphere. The 30s saw the first attempts in this direction. The modern school, the apartment, the hospital all represent architecture that is economical and serves basic functions of contemporary man, with regard to new urban planning, a free-plan approach, industrial prefabricated construction and maintaining the link between man and nature. Modern in this case does not mean transient, but rather socially aware, economical, functional, rational, minimal, serial. Due to the need for more prudent economics and the new materials, construction opportunities and serial production made available by industry, the problem in preservation of this architecture lies mostly in the ageing of the visible concrete, poor isolation, thermal bridges, difficulty in obtaining obsolete materials, and standards that have since changed. Slovenian Modernism of the 30s influenced Slovenian Postmodernism in the 80s, while the Modernism of the 60s influenced the Slovenian architecture of the late 90s and the first decade of the new millennium.

Contextual Practices

Apart from internal influences, Germanic and French influences most marked the 20th-century development of the Slovenian school of architecture. The starting point of 20th-century Slovenian architecture was undisputedly Vienna, where Plečnik, Fabiani and Vurnik all studied. Even though the first, short-lived, university in Slovenia had been founded as early as the time of Napoleon's Illyrian Provinces, in 1810 (Écoles centrales), the first permanent Slovenian university was not built until 1919. The Ljubljana School of Architecture was founded in 1920, mostly due to the efforts of Ivan Vurnik. After his teaching spell at the Prague Arts and Crafts School, Plečnik organised his seminar group at the University of Ljubljana in 1921. His school was based on the medieval tradition of the master-apprentice relationship and on the Schinkel-Semper-Wagner theory of developing architecture through craft. It is from these traditions that his "Principle of Dressing the Building" (Bekleidungsprinzip) ¹³ originates. Plečnik's students also independently familiarised themselves with Choisy's book *Histoire de l'architecture*, which explains the development of form through the development of technique. Upon his arrival at the university after the Second World War, in 1946, Edvard Ravnikar, who, after graduating under Plečnik, worked for Le Corbusier for a time, upgraded Plečnik's tradition by implementing French influences. He retained Plečnik's seminar-style work mode, his treatment of detail, facade, attention to drawing and presentation, and his attitude towards local context, but Le Corbusier's influence can be seen in the development of spatial concepts, the reinforced-concrete construction, and above all in the understanding of the spirit of the times and the new social role that it was now intended for the architect. Ravnikar's teaching method was based on scientific doubt, experiment, analysis and synthesis. This method

27, 28 Plečnik: NUK, detajl fasade

Ravnikar: Moderna galerija, detajl fasade

29, 30 Plečnik: NUK, okno na Gosposko

Ravnikar: Cankarjev dom: okno na Erjavčevo

31, 32 Plečnik: NUK, glavni vhod

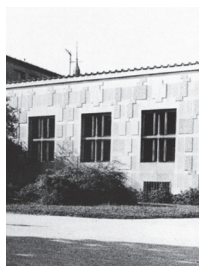
Ravnikar: Cankarjev dom, glavni vhod

Jugovec, Marjan Šorli, Miloš Bonča, Janez Lajovic, Majda Dobravec, Grega Košak, Vladimir B. Mušič in Marko Mušič. Od tujih vplivov so v tem kontekstu najbolj prisotni vplivi japonske tradicionalne in moderne arhitekture, Finska z Aaltom in ideje Team X.

Plečnikovo in Ravnikarjevo arhitekturo družijo pozornost, ki jo posvečata obravnavanju *locusa* (prostora, kamor umeščata svojo arhitekturo) in detajlov. Pri obravnavanju *locusa* je značilno, da v kontekst hiše načrtno vgrajujeta zgodovinski spomin kraja bodisi z materialom, obliko ali strukturo. Tako je na primer Plečnik v fasado Narodne in univerzitetne knjižnice vgradil kamenje, ki je ostalo na lokaciji ob porušitvi Auerspergovega dvorca, Ravnikar pa je, na primer, na Trgu republike uporabil zavržene litoželezne klasicistične ograje, ki jih je povojna politična oblast odstranjevala z vrtov meščanskih vil. Pri obravnavanju detajla je za oba značilna pozornost, ki jo posvečata detajliranju kljuk, ograj in lestencev. V večini primerov konstrukcijski detajli in strukturiranje materiala fasadnega plašča nadomeščajo ornament.

was also suggested by CIAM.¹⁴ Other architects that played an important role in the preservation and reinterpretation of the Slovenian architectural tradition, and the functional heritage of the Slovenian countryside – in a pedagogical, theoretical and practical sense – were Ivan Vurnik, Dušan Grabrijan, Marjan Mušič, Anton Bitenc, Oton Jugovec, Marjan Šorli, Miloš Bonča, Janez Lajovic, Majda Dobravec, Grega Košak, Vladimir B. Mušič and Marko Mušič. The most notable foreign influences in this context are traditional and modern Japanese architecture, Finnish architecture (Alvar Aalto) and the ideas of Team X.

Plečnik's and Ravnikar's architecture have in common the attention paid to the treatment of the locus (the location of the building) and the treatment of details. For the locus, it is typical that they intentionally implement historical memory into the building, whether through material, form or structure. Consider, for example Plečnik's re-used stones on the facade of the National and University Library, left at the location after the collapse of the Auersperg's Manor. Ravnikar, on the other hand, in designing Republic Square, re-used the pre-war cast-iron fences around the bourgeois villas in the very centre of Ljubljana, which were previously removed by the political power of the post-war regime. In the treatment of detail, the two have in common the attention paid to the design of hooks, fences and lighting. Also, in most cases, the details of construction and structure of the material represent substitutes for ornament.



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Plečnikovo arhitekturo označujemo kot »prožni klasicizem«, Ravnikarjevo pa kot »avtentični modernizem«. ¹⁵ Poglavitna razlika je v načinu produkcije detajlov in obravnavanju koncepta prostora; medtem ko pri Plečniku govorimo še o obrtniškem detajlu, govorimo pri Ravnikarju o industrijskem detajlu. Plečnikov prostor je klasičen, statičen, Ravnikarjev ima moderno dinamiko, ki temelji na Le Corbusierjevih prostorskih konceptih. Ravnikar sam pravi: »Zanimivo je, da je na primer prav Francoz Le Corbusier pomagal prestopiti Slovencem tisti prag, ki ga Plečnik ni več zmogel.« Ravnikar piše, da ima Plečnikova arhitektura v sebi skrite važne sestavine za bodočnost. ¹⁶ Poudarja njegovo navezanost na Wagnerjevo šolo in angleško gibanje Arts and Crafts s prepričanjem o socialnem poslanstvu arhitekture. Kot pristno moderne elemente pri Plečnikovi arhitekturi izpostavi smisel za iskanje novih možnosti, elementarnost in strukturiranje materialov, kar je vse prav tako značilno za Ravnikarjevo arhitekturo. Ena izmed pomembnih specifik slovenske arhitekture je povezava med moderno arhitekturo in nacionalnim vprašanjem, saj smo

Plečnik's architecture is labelled "Flexible Classicism", Ravnikar's "Authentic Modernism". ¹⁵ The main difference lies in the production of detail and the treatment of space; whereas Plečnik's detail is based on craft, Ravnikar's is industrial. Plečnik saw space as classical, static, while Ravnikar's use of space has a modern dynamic, based on a free plan. He stated: "Curiously, it was a Frenchman, Le Corbusier, who helped Slovenians to cross a barrier that Plečnik could not." Ravnikar claims that Plečnik's architecture contains important ingredients for the future. He emphasises his attachment to Wagner's school and the English Arts and Crafts movement, with its commitment to the social vocation of architecture. The elements of Plečnik's architecture that Ravnikar considers genuinely modern are the emphasis on always searching for new possibilities, for the elemental and for structuring material, all of which is also typical of Ravnikar's architecture. One of the important elements of Slovenian architecture is the link between Modernist architecture and the national question, as in the

- 33 Pogled na Kranjsko Goro
 34 Detajl kmečke hiše v Podgori pri naselju Dobre Polje na Dolenjskem
 35 Kozolec
 36 Del skednja na Malem Vrhu pri Šmarju na Dolenjskem
 37 Pastirsko naselje na Pokljuki

Slovenci v 20. stoletju pripadali različnim političnim konglomeracijam od Avstro-Ogrske, prek Jugoslavije do samostojne Slovenije l. 1991. Nacionalno vprašanje je bilo še posebej aktualno v 30. in 60. letih dvajsetega stoletja, prav to pa so tudi leta, ki predstavljajo vrhunec Plečnikovega oz. Ravnikarjevega ustvarjanja. Leta 1932 je izšla knjiga Josipa Vidmarja »Kulturni problem slovenstva«, kjer prvič formulira stališča slovenske inteligence do narodnostnega vprašanja. Vidmar ugotavlja, da je za obstoj naroda ključnega pomena ohranjanje naravnih danosti in življenjskih zakonitosti, ki so se razvile na podlagi naravnih danosti, saj pravi, da je narava najosnovnejša vitalna sila pri nastanku naroda.

Ravnikar pravi takole: »V arhitekturi se narava vidi v konstrukciji, kot tvorbi fizike sveta. Njen smisel je v nas vseh in tudi pri živalih, insektih in v sestojih nežive materije je. Lepota v arhitekturi je lepota konstruiranega, ki je odsev nečesa. Tu se začne vsa težava, ko bi to radi povedali z besedo. Odsev česa? Nečesa, kar je v človeku in je človeško (še le ta odsev napravi človeka človeka, kjer ga ni, tudi človeka ni), mislimo od renesanse naprej, ko so verjeli, da je to povedano v Vitruviju in so Alberti, Da Vinci, Michelangelo, Collona vedno znova razlagali svoja spoznanja in odkritja v naravi kot odsev, kar je potem izraženo v formi, ker drugače ne more biti. Tisti odsev spregovori, če najdemo, izdelamo formulo, ki je njegov zapis.«

20th century, Slovenians fell under various political formations, from Austro-Hungarian Empire, through Yugoslavia, to an independent Slovenia, finally, in 1991. The national question was especially prominent in the 30s and the 60s, the years that also represent the heyday of Plečnik and Ravnikar. In 1932, Josip Vidmar published his book, *The Cultural Problem of the Slovenes*, formulating the standpoint of the Slovenian intelligentsia with regard to the national question. He finds the preservation of nature and its adherent laws of life vital to a nation's existence, as nature is the most primeval force shaping a nation.

Or in Ravnikar's words: "In architecture, nature presents itself in construction, formed by the physics of the world. Her purpose lies in all of us, including animals, insects and inanimate matter. Beauty in architecture is the beauty of the constructed, reflecting something. It is difficult to put this in words ... reflecting what exactly? Something that is present in man and is human (this very reflection makes humans human; if it's absent, then so is man). From the Renaissance on, when it was believed that this 'something' can be found in Vitruvius, Alberti, Da Vinci, Michelangelo and Collona regularly explained their findings within nature as a reflection. However, they were only able to express this in form. That reflection can speak to us, if we come up with a formula that forms it." Ravnikar spoke of metaphors of life transferred into architectural language. To quote him further: "Here, everything that is alive, everything that breathes, appears, horses hurtle."



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Gre torej za metafore življenja, prenesene v arhitekturni jezik. »Tu se pojavi živo in vse, kar diha, konji zdrvijo«, pravi Ravnikar. Energija žive metafore. V tem smislu postane arhitektura umetniška kreacija, alegorija, poetični privid, inovacija. Njena inovacijska moč pa pomeni tudi začetek nove tradicije. Pri tem si lahko pomagamo z Groysovo definicijo umetniškega dela, ki pravi: »Inovacija torej pomeni strategijo, ki pozitivno in negativno nadaljevanje tradicije preplete tako, da sta pri tem z največjo možno jasnostjo in intenzivnostjo oblikovani kontinuiteta in diskontinuiteta tradicije. Umetnina s tem za trenutek postane kraj, kjer hierarhične razlike izginejo, moč časa pa je premagana.«¹⁷

Ravnikarjeva arhitektura, ki izhaja iz moderne paradigme, kjer je prav pojem časa vključen v nov prostorski koncept, s tem postane brezčasna, tako rekoč klasična. In prav zato, ker si je v svojem izvoru in z močjo svoje osebne metaforike resnično upala biti avtentično moderna, hkrati pa se je vedno držala univerzalnih zakonov

We see here the energy of a pure metaphor. In this sense, architecture becomes artistic creation, allegory, a poetic mirage, an innovation. However, its power of innovation also means the beginning of a new tradition. Groys's definition of a work of art can be of use here: "Innovation therefore means a strategy that intertwines the positive and the negative continuation of tradition in such a way that both continuity and discontinuity of tradition are formed with the greatest intensity and clarity possible. This makes a work of art a place where hierarchical differences vanish and where the power of time lies defeated."¹⁷

Ravnikar's architecture, which originates from a Modernist paradigm, where the notion of time is included in a new concept of space, thus becomes timeless, even classical. And as it had dared, in its inception, and through the power of personal metaphor, to be authentically modern, while at the same time holding to universal

arhitekturne discipline in arhitektovih osebnih karakteristik, jo danes lahko obravnavamo kot umetniško delo in kot klasično tradicijo moderne slovenske arhitekture. Zanimivo pa je, da Plečnik skozi celo svojo ustvarjalno pot ostaja zvest svojemu osebnemu slogu, ideje s svojo osebno metaforiko le pogloblja in jih drugače interpretira, medtem ko Ravnikar v svojem zadnjem ustvarjalnem obdobju, tukaj mislim predvsem na prizidek k Narodni galeriji z začetka 90. let, dobesedno zanika vse pridobitve moderne in celo svoj osebni arhitekturni izraz, kar priča o vplivu mode, konkretnije o povzemanju idej postmodernizma. V tem smislu je bil Plečnik veliko trdnjeje zasidran v nadčasovni dimenziji arhitekture (*Architectura Perennis*), k čemur je prav gotovo pripomoglo dejstvo, da je bil vse svoje življenje iskreno veren.

Vsa slovenska zgodovina je povezana z jezikom. Skozi razum in osebni značaj razvita arhitektura, ki temelji na civilizacijskih, geografskih in zgodovinsko-političnih danostih, se skozi anatomijo metafore približa tudi narodnostnim karakteristikam, saj po Josipu Vidmarju¹⁸ narodnost pomeni značaj kolektivne individualnosti in predstavlja duševne zakonitosti, ki so vdlane v človeka. Plečnik in Ravnikar sta, podobno kot Aalto, Gaudi, Mackintosh pa tudi Miguel Fisac, svojo poetiko gradila prav na točki čutenja, prepoznanja, priznanja in globoko premišljene osebne interpretacije narodnostnih zakonitosti, vtkanih v lastni in kolektivni značaj ljudi, ki tu živijo, saj to, v nasprotju z internacionalizmom, čutita in sprejemata kot svojo poglavitno nalogo v kontekstu razvoja moderne arhitekture. To pa jima je dalo tudi dodatno moč, da sta lahko v 20. stoletju razvila svoji prepoznavni arhitekturni govorici »prožnega klasicizma« in »avtentičnega modernizma«, ki predstavljata temelj moderne slovenske arhitekturne tradicije 20. stoletja. Kar pa je bil konec koncev tudi njun cilj, saj Ravnikar pravi: »Arhitekt toliko velja in pomeni, kolikor se mu je posrečilo zgraditi svoj formski svet.« Dela obeh arhitektov, Plečnika in Ravnikarja, preveva izraz tiste značilno slovenske, trpke lepote, skozi katero lahko prepoznamo lirski značaj ljudi, ki tu živijo, in ki mu pravimo duša naroda. To misel lahko povežemo z znanim Wittgensteinovim stavkom: »Meje mojega jezika so moje svetloste.« Pri tem seveda mislimo arhitekturni jezik slovenskega modernizma, katerega sta Plečnik in Ravnikar načrtno izoblikovala in razširila prek meja Slovenije.

Lahko celo govorimo o inovativni kontekstualnosti Plečnikove in Ravnikarjeve arhitekture, saj jima je z osebno reinterpretacijo uspelo premagati bipolarnost nasprotja tradicionalno-moderno in razviti specifičen in prepoznaven jezik slovenskega modernizma 20. stoletja. V tem primeru govorimo o arhitekturi kot umetniškem delu. Izraz »moderen« tako v opisovanju njunega dela pomeni predvsem osebni, inovativni, s koreninami v tradiciji. Govorimo o obdobju, ko še ni bilo industrijsko izdelanih gradbenih elementov in detajlov, zato so jih morali arhitekti sami oblikovati. Pri vrednotenju te arhitekture gre zato izpostaviti prav kriterij inovacije in avtorsko prepoznavnega detajla, ki ima svojo tradicijo v dediščini slovenske kulturne krajine. Avtorska inovacija pri Plečnikovi in Ravnikarjevi arhitekturi ter v delih nekaterih njunih učencev (Milan Mihelič, Savin Sever,

laws of architectural discipline and the architect's personal characteristics, it can today be considered a work of art and a part of the Slovenian tradition of Modernist architecture. It is interesting that Plečnik remained faithful to his personal style; he was only deepening his ideas through his personal metaphors, while Ravnikar, during his last creative period (especially with the extension to the National Gallery of Slovenia in the early 90s), literally denies all Modernist assets and even his own architectural expression; this only testifies to the influence of "fashion", summarising Postmodernist ideas. Plečnik obviously remained more firmly rooted in the dimension of timelessness in architecture (*"Architectura Perennis"*); that he had been profoundly religious all of his life certainly contributed to this.

All Slovenian history is tied up with language. Architecture built through reason and personal character and based on civilisational, geographical and historically political parameters, comes – through the anatomy of metaphor – close to the characteristics of national identity. According to Josip Vidmar,¹⁸ national identity means the character of collective individuality that represents man-implemented mental laws. Plečnik and Ravnikar, like Aalto, Gaudi, Mackintosh and Miguel Fisac, based their poetics on feeling, recognition, acknowledgement and on a carefully planned personal interpretation of national identity; the latter being implemented in the personal and collective character of people living here. In contrast to Internationalism, Plečnik and Ravnikar considered this their foremost task in the context of the development of modern architecture. Hence the additional drive to develop their recognisable architectural language, that of "Flexible Classicism" and of "Authentic Modernism", which represent the cornerstone of Slovenia's Modernist architectural tradition of the 20th century. Not that they had aimed at anything else, or as Ravnikar put it: "An architect's worth is in managing to build his own world of form." The works of both Plečnik and Ravnikar, are pervaded with the typically Slovenian bitter beauty, through which we can immediately recognise the people's lyrical character and which we can call the soul of the nation. We can link this thought with Wittgenstein's well-known adage: "The limits of my language mean the limits of my world," in which, of course, we are thinking about the architectural language of Slovenian Modernism, which was intentionally formed and spread beyond the Slovenian borders by Plečnik and Ravnikar.

We could even discuss Plečnik's and Ravnikar's architecture in terms of innovative contextuality, as they have managed to overcome, through personal reinterpretation, the bipolarity of the contrast between the traditional and the modern, and to develop a specific, recognisable language of Slovenian Modernism. Referring to their architecture as artistic work, the term "Modern" bears, above all, the connotation of something personal, innovative and rooted in tradition. Due to the lack of availability of construction materials and detail at the time, architects were forced to develop their own. It is therefore important to focus on the criterion of innovation and detail authorship, with tradition originating from Slovenian rural heritage. Innovation in Plečnik's and Ravnikar's architecture, and in

- 38 Plečnik: NUK, detajl ograje v čitalnici
 39 Ravnikar: OLO, detajl ograje na stopnišču
 40 Plečnik: Žale, detajl fasade
 41 Ravnikar: Ferantov vrt, detajl fasade



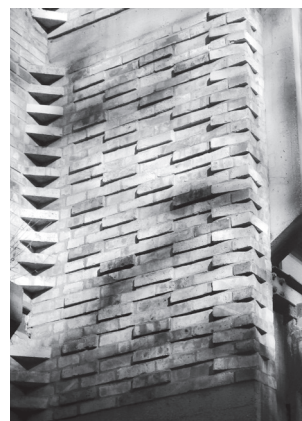
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Oton Jugovec) predstavlja osnovno merilo kvalitete. Pri varovanju in ohranjanju teh del se zato v večini primerov lahko odločamo le za rekonstrukcijo. Posebno pozornost velja upoštevati tudi pri ohranjanju in obdelavi materialov ter pri fasadnih kompozicijah. Lastniki njunih objektov se morajo zato zavedati, da so to umetniška dela, nacionalni spomeniki z najvišjo kulturno in tržno vrednostjo, čeprav večina od njih uradno nima tega statusa, zato morajo svoje želje prilagajati zmožnostim in funkciji arhitekture in ne obratno.

the work of some of their students (Milan Mihelič, Savin Sever, Oton Jugovec) represents a basic quality standard. Consequentially, the preservation of their work in the main consists only of reconstruction. We need to be especially attentive to the choice/treatment of materials and facade compositions. The owners of Plečnik's and Ravnikar's buildings must be aware that they possess works of art, national monuments of the highest cultural and financial value (although most of these buildings do not officially have this status), and should therefore adjust their wishes to the abilities and function of the architecture, rather than the other way around.

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